

INSIDE:



KEEPING COOL WITH LOCAL FLORA

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NEW HOME FOR CHATHAM ARTS

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➤ GAINES STEER IN FULL DISCLOSURE

➤ CYNTHIA RAXTER: PLANTING CORN

Columbia, Maryland lessons for Chatham Park, IV

by Gaines Steer

PART FOUR OF A FOUR-PART SERIES

After the talk, the audience was asked to provide brief statements concerning their takeaways (lessons learned from Columbia that might be considered for the growth and development of Chatham County). The actual flip charts recorded that day contain sentence fragments that were an attempt to concisely capture the gist of the audience statement. I have attempted to flesh out the sentence fragments into full sentence form to make them more sensible to those who were not present. Oh, BTW, for others who were not present, please don't shoot the messenger. Remember these are not my opinions, my role was to record what others said. Having said that, here are the takeaways...

Principle: Agreements needed to be continuously monitored and enforced over time.

Concern/Question: What happens to the agreements when a corporation is sold?

Concern/Question: What best principles/practices might be applied to govern educational development?

Concern/Question: What principle/practice will allow (or ensure) that existing stakeholders participate and/or are involved?

Perspective: Regarding the perception of dissension: Currently the media leaves the impression that the community is polarized with clear lines for and against. However, there must be a spectrum of responses.

Question: How can we provide outlets for those other voices to emerge?

Fact: The composition and the motivation of stakeholders will undoubtedly change as new residents move into Chatham Park.

Concern: Lower income families in service industries and other occupations will need affordable housing. How will affordable housing be addressed?

Principle: Listening is always valuable.

Principle: For voices to be heard, community discussion forums require a set time and place.

Principle: After listening, action is required.

Concern/Question: County seems to need answers to the "How?" for infrastructure development. Examples:

- How do we provide education for the growing population?
- How do we create parks from the developer's set-asides?
- How will the influx of large numbers of new residents change aspects of governance?

Principle and Question: Rouse and the developers of Columbia provided a strong vision for "Growing as a People." What does this mean for us?

Concerns/Questions: What values/principles will guide the development of Chatham Park? Can we create a mechanism for a dialogue between the developers of Chatham Park and various stakeholders that is more satisfying?

Solution proposal: Perhaps an online community forum would allow voices to be heard.

Realization: A power shift is inevitable. It is likely that political power will be dominated because of sheer numbers of residents of Chatham Park.

Principle: Community is a verb!

Gaines Steer, long-time Chatham County resident, was the first Community Organizer hired in "The Next America," as this large and innovative community was described. Situated on 15,000 acres between Washington, DC and Baltimore Maryland, Columbia was the brainchild of Jim Rouse and Co., a socially conscious developer, whose development style led to national recognition {cover of Time Magazine, Presidential Medal of Freedom, etc}. This final segment in a series of four articles is based on a presentation he made in Pittsboro on 2/28/16.

Embedding Sustainability Solutions in a Master Planned Community

by Thomas D'Alesandro

The Research Triangle Region of North Carolina consistently sits at the top of "best place" lists — to live, grow a company or raise a family. Our reputation is an open secret, and the region is expected to add 40,000 new residents a year over the next 20 years. At the same time, the region's renowned research park, The Research Triangle Park, is nearing full occupancy.

Chatham Park, a proposed master planned community totaling nearly 8,000 acres at the intersection of two major highways in Pittsboro, N.C., represents a future anchor to one of the nation's fastest growing, economically vibrant and desirable areas.

Chatham Park is a new community designed to conserve significant open space, establish vibrant village and town centers, and attractively connect neighborhoods with businesses, entertainment, education and nature though an extensive trail system. It will be a place where the human and the natural connect in more rewarding ways — where you'll be able to walk out your front door and experience the energy of Main Street or walk out your back door and feel the serenity of a quiet nature preserve. It builds on the traditions of other communities that successfully sought to create more environmentally, socially, and economically sustainable places.

Precedents include two communities I have had the privilege to develop: Reston, Virginia, the nation's first planned community, which has been recognized as much for its extensive natural areas as for its vibrant town center, and The Woodlands, north of Houston, Texas, which was "designed with nature" to allow a robust city to rise within a thriving forest.

Chatham Park will be the best expression of smart growth values, incorporating long-range, regional considerations of sustainability: Open space preservation. Targeted goals to reduce natural resource consumption. Connected technology.

The Research Triangle Regional Partnership's new Cleantech Cluster has become Chatham Park's partner in a collaborative effort to commercialize the exciting innovations of over 200 companies engaged in clean technologies in the Research Triangle Region. This strategic alliance will permit Chatham Park to raise the bar on sustainability solutions within the community.

Chatham Park will be built from the ground up with digitized infrastructure that will allow for the monitoring and data processing needed to achieve large reductions in the use of water, electricity and carbon-based fuels.

This means that not only will Chatham Park be preserving forest and land as its precedent communities have done, but it will extend beyond their achievements to make visible to residents and businesses their ability to conserve a more comprehensive and significant range of natural resources. That Chatham Park will be fed by a vision of not doing piece-meal development — a Planned Development District will overlay the entire community — means systems-thinking is achievable. This may be Chatham Park's most distinctive urban planning innovation.

With 1,000 acres set aside for accommodating businesses, Chatham Park will contain the largest new center for bringing employees together in North Carolina. The community will attract a range of jobs, as the region continues to draw expanding industries in the areas of technology, life sciences and medicine. The residents of Chatham Park will be able to live where they work, creating a greater work-life balance. When fully built out over the next 30 years, Chatham Park will have over 20,000 homes clustered in five villages.

While I am proud that Reston and The Woodlands demonstrated the ecological advantages of taking a holistic approach to community planning, of being in one place where you could live, work and play (not to mention the health advantages of living surrounded by natural beauty), they could not have been designed to deploy new technologies that address energy, water, or waste management challenges with an integrated information and communication systems-based approach. In this way, Chatham Park will be different. We call it a "future enabled community." What this means is that Chatham Park will be a resilient community.

Chatham Park will provide demonstration and deployment projects that are crucial to bringing clean technology into widespread market readiness through scaled performance and cost assessment over a build-out period of several decades.

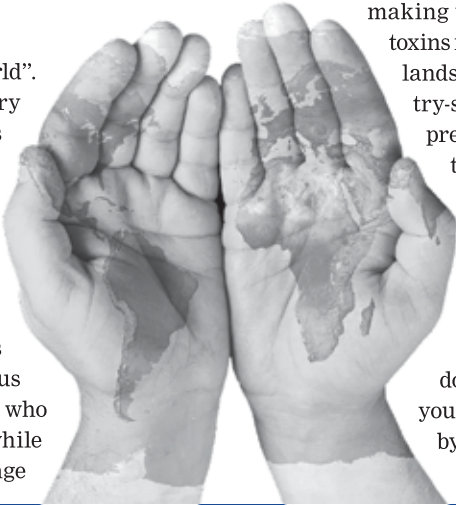
Chatham Park is a privately funded development and the clean technologies deployed there will be pragmatic. We are "blinders-off" to the reality that emerging technologies face a marketplace that is risk averse, requires high

SOLUTIONS CONTINUED, PAGE 2

Be the change the world needs

by Joe Jacob

"Be the change you wish to see in the world". This quote by Mahatma Gandhi seems very appropriate in my life right now. You see, as far as I am concerned, the world is totally out of control. Mass killings of innocent people, terrorists from outside and from within threatening to eradicate western civilization, a Congress that does nothing but serve itself instead of its constituents, corporations that eat up their employees while those at the top take home outrageous salaries, segments of society hating those who are different, the wealthy getting richer while the poor are getting poorer, climate change



making us feel insecure about the future, toxins in our food, air and water, and urban landscapes spreading out into the countryside like an untreatable cancer, are pretty depressing things. I have come to realize that the only way to change things is for me to be the change I want to see in the world because individually I am not powerful enough to make the changes that are necessary. Changing the way you see and do things is not easy, but it is doable if you take one thing at a time. You begin by replacing what appears as negative with positive thoughts and actions.

My passion is being outside in Nature, often paddling down the Haw River. So, when the Bynum Outpost Coordinator for The Haw River Canoe & Kayak Co. recently asked me if the river was clean, I had to replace my anger for the way our culture is treating rivers and the fish and wildlife that depend on them, with reflection on how the Haw River has changed since passage of the Clean Water Act. All in all, since the Act passed Congress, water quality in the Haw River has improved. Oldtimers will tell you that before the Act, the river would turn colors each day depending on the dyes that were being used in the textile mills upriver. Fish kills were almost a daily event. Today, it is not what you can see, but what you cannot see that is of concern. The river is carrying nutrients that are causing algal blooms in Jordan

CHANGE CONTINUED, PAGE 8

DISPATCH

Local Friends of State Parks Chapter hosts info meeting

Friends of State Parks is holding an informational meeting about forming a local chapter to support the Lower Haw River State Natural Area in Chatham County. The meeting is open to the public and will be held at the Bynum Ruritan Club on **Tuesday, July 12**, at 6:30 p.m. Friends of State Parks (FSP) is a nonprofit organization with chapters throughout NC dedicated to protecting and enhancing the North Carolina park system. Local chapters can use FSP's tax exempt status while maintaining control over all donation funds. Representatives from Friends of State Parks and NC State Parks will be on hand to discuss the benefits of forming a local chapter to support the Lower Haw River SNA and answer questions. Community support provided through a local chapter is important in assisting NC State Parks with protecting this special place and with initiatives underway for a network of State Parks hiking and paddle trails.

The Lower Haw River State Natural Area consists of about 1,100 acres owned by NC State Parks along both sides of the river. It stretches from above US 15-501 near Bynum to below US 64 at the Jordan Lake State Recreation Area, providing over four miles of river and stream buffers. It includes Significant Natural Areas, habitat for endangered species and beautiful rugged scenery. NC State Parks established State Natural Areas within the state park system to focus on conservation and preservation of special places.

The meeting is being organized by the Haw River Assembly. For more information contact info@hawriver.org.

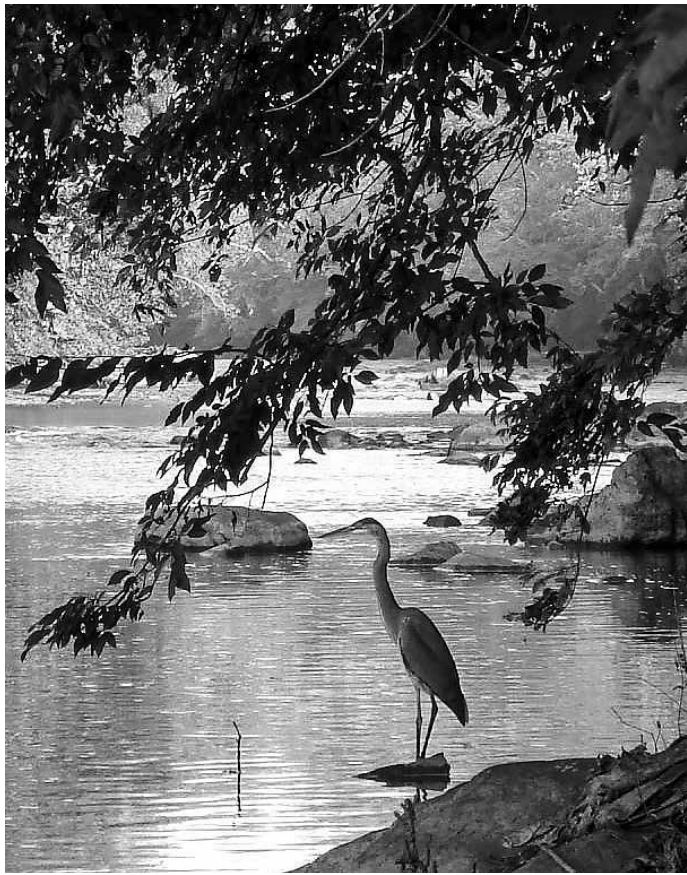


PHOTO COURTESY ELAINE CHIOSSO

Developer Smith buys more land

Developer Tim Smith paid \$4.2 million for 647 acres of undeveloped land across the river from the planned 7,200-acre Chatham Park community north of Pittsboro, reports *The Chapel Hill News*.

Smith, owner and partner at Preston Development in Cary, bought the land known as the Retreat at Haw River on June 8 through his recently formed Flying Crown Ranch LLC., county records indicate.

Charlotte-based Crescent Communities held two lots off Bynum Ridge Road totaling 573 acres since 2006 and 2008, records show; two smaller lots totaling 74 acres were purchased in 2010.

The combined cost for all four parcels was \$28.9 million. The county approved a 67-home project for the site in 2007, but Crescent Communities filed for Chapter 11 bankruptcy in 2009 and never broke ground.

The company had worked with Chatham officials as recently as 2014 on a revised site plan for 393 single-family homes. The new plan allowed for a more dense development in return for Crescent conserving at least 40 percent of the land as natural and green space.

Raleigh-based CBRE most recently advertised the land for sale at \$5.9 million.

Chatham Park announced last month that The Eco Group would develop that project's first phase—44 acres of commercial property—early next year. The second, 95-acre phase is going through the rezoning process.

It is unclear whether this latest purchase will become part of the Chatham Park development.

MORE BRIEFS, MORE CONTENT: WWW.CHATHAMCOUNTYLINE.ORG

Pittsboro-Siler City C&V Bureau wins top state award

The Pittsboro-Siler City Convention & Visitors Bureau (CVB), a countywide organization, won a top 2015 award from the Destination Marketing Association of North Carolina (DMANC) for its efforts to market the county as a visitor destination.

The CVB won the Gold Award for Best Website and Online Communications, the highest award for that category.

"We actually won the award late last year, but email issues at the time meant that I did not receive notice of the award," said Neha Shah, director of the CVB. "We were thrilled to learn that we had, in fact, won a top award."

County Manager Renee Paschal said, "This award is yet again proof that we have a very successful CVB. It is a very small office that accomplishes more than many larger CVBs and is fully funded by occupancy tax proceeds."

Paschal said that the CVB is a major reason why Chatham County continues to see annual growth in visitor-related spending. "The latest report, released in August 2015, showed a three percent increase in visitor spending from 2013 to 2014. This generated approximately \$570,000 in local sales tax and property tax revenues."

SOLUTIONS CONTINUED FROM PAGE 1

rates of return, is marked by incumbent technologies, and often has policy and program hurdles to overcome.

However, this project represents a significant opportunity to demonstrate emerging and enabling technologies, helping overcome barriers to their widespread adoption. The Chatham Park—Research Triangle Cleantech Cluster partnership will institute a holistic, phased approach that will showcase the commercial viability of clean technology today and into the future. As a greenfield, Chatham Park represents a significant opportunity to model savings from efficiency technologies and allow capital resources to be diverted to alternative applications.

Events like Meeting of the Minds shows the interest there is in putting the new powers we possess to use in making our cities and towns more efficient—w and more livable. Endeavors like Chatham Park provide an especially promising venue for executing the new technologies, measuring them, and demonstrating their benefits to a world much in need of their positive results.

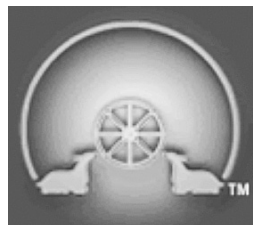
Thomas D'Alesandro brings over 25 years of experience operating real estate companies—development and management organizations of up to 1,300 people—and has overseen the nation's largest mixed use master planned communities, including The Woodlands, TX, and Summerlin, NV. Mr. D'Alesandro's Blakefield, LLC has been advising clients globally on development strategy and execution since its founding in 2010.

Conjugation of the verb "to hope"

BY LOU LIPSITZ

I hoped
—the night came anyway
I hoped
—the night came anyway
Is this the way to
do it?
No. Begin again.
I hoped,
today.
I will still hope tomorrow.
One day,
I will risk everything.

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Chatham County Line is a community newspaper serving all of Chatham County as well as the southern part of Orange. Our mission is to inform our community by providing a forum "where all voices are heard." We seek all views and ideas about our community, and we report on important matters—including our cultural life—comprehensively and in-depth. Our commitment is to create the best-written, best-edited and most stylish community newspaper anywhere. Chatham County Line is published ten times a year.

Editor and Publisher: Julian Sereno

Page Layout/Design & Ad Design
Hart Palmer Design,
hpalmer@mebtel.net

Website Design: UniqueOrn.com

Social Media Editor: Chris Bouton

Chatham County Line is wholly owned by
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Hey, look me over! and over. . . and over. . .

by Brenda Denzler

“Man looketh on the outward appearance,” the Christian Bible says, “but God looketh on the heart.” The NC legislature, unable to see into the heart so as to legislate good and proper things for we the people, has decided to rely on DNA instead.

I refer, of course, to the passage of the now-infamous House Bill 2, forcing transgendered people to deny what they know in their hearts and only use public restrooms that match what their DNA says. The rationale for this public regulation of the private bodily functions of citizens is protection—not protection of the transgendered, but protection of women and children. (Presumably, the male portion of the populace needs no such protection.)

How does the legislature expect this law to be enforced? Are we going to post security details at the doors to all public restrooms and require those entering to prove their gender by flashing a copy of their birth certificate? A sort of TSA for public loos?

Or maybe we’ll have the local police set up random gender checks in front of public restrooms, like those annoying roadside driver’s license checks?

Will physical verification of a match between what the birth certificate says and the private parts of the would-be restroom-user be required?

And will the lines be very long at these checkpoints? I may have to practice looking relaxed and casual while standing in line with my legs desperately crossed....

It’s a nice touch, though, tying all of this into the protection of women and children—a time-honored rationale for both good and incredibly bad social policies. The question is how to tell which it is. One way is to ask whether the thing that women and children are being protected from is something that is actually happening but shouldn’t. Or is it, instead, something that might happen but shouldn’t, and if so, how likely is it, really?

Our esteemed governor has said that to

his knowledge there have been no cases of a transgendered person using their new gender identity to enter restrooms and assault anyone. And let’s face it...since when has it been necessary to assume a different gender in order to go into a public restroom and commit an assault?

Mostly, I’m bewildered. What sparked this odd ruling? Why are transgendered people being singled out as criminally threatening?

Maybe it’s this: For the NC legislature and HB2 supporters, transgendered people ARE threatening. To them, the transgendered are, at the very least, a “crime against nature.” I’d be willing to wager that many a sermon of late has suggested that the transgendered are also a “crime against God.” If this is what you think, then it makes perfect sense to extend the “criminality” of the transgendered into the legal realm in whatever way you can.

I have to admit that I kind of understand where the HB2 supporters are coming from. I know of a person who chooses to present themselves as ambiguous in their gender. You can’t even tell by their name whether they are a man with strong feminine characteristics, or a woman with strong masculine characteristics. I find it difficult to know how to refer to this person—he, she...they? But I don’t find this person threatening. Disconcerting? Yes. Because I don’t know how to think about or react to them using the categories of thought or the pronouns we typically use. But threatening? Not really.

Know what I would find threatening? Going into the ladies’ loo and encountering some big, burly guy who was born female but has gone through sexual reassignment surgery. Now THAT, ladies and gentlemen, would alarm me. If I was a 13-year-old girl instead of a 60-ish woman with some spit and fire in her, it would alarm me even more.

So much for protecting women and children....

What HB2 really protects, IMHO, is the sensibilities (some would say “prejudices”) of its promoters. It gives legal legitimacy to their discomfort with and moral outrage against

people who are different from them in ways they apparently cannot begin to understand.

Not only does HB2 not really protect women and children, it has the power to hurt some of the very women it was supposedly written to protect.

“Has anyone noticed people giving them weird looks since this whole HB2 thing?” asked a woman in one of my online breast cancer support groups.

“I had a double mastectomy,” she wrote, “and most of the time I don’t wear foobs [breast prostheses; fake breasts] when I go out. I just go flat-chested. But now since this HB2 thing, I seem to be getting stares from people when I go into public restrooms.”

Judging from the response she got, she was not alone.

mother, or one of your best friends.... Then it can all feel overwhelming pretty quickly.

I’m rather self-conscious when I go to the gym wearing an exercise bra, which doesn’t accommodate a boob very well. I usually wear a baggy t-shirt over it and kind of hunch my shoulders so that maybe people won’t notice a one-boobed woman plodding along on the treadmill.

But since that discussion about HB2 came up in my support group, I’m standing a little straighter on the treadmill. One day I may even wear a form-fitting tank top instead of a baggy T.

Brenda Denzler was diagnosed with inflammatory breast cancer in 2009. She became a cancer survivor on the very day she was diagnosed.

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Civil War Parallels, Part II

The South—and North Carolina—had considerable infighting. Brigadier General Lawrence O'Bryan Branch, who had no military training, did not realize that the Northern Army was coming by land against the capital, "New Berne." When Zeb Vance found that his 26th North Carolina, along with the 23rd, had been abandoned by Branch, he cut west for the swamps, reached Brice's Creek, and plunged in on his horse to show his men that crossing the creek was safe. But it was not just deep but "mean." He lost his seat, went down "like a brick," and had to be rescued. President Jefferson Davis used this as fodder for why he withheld promotions and medals from North Carolina boys. Why he really did, according to Vance, was their independence. They sent their cotton out by blockade runners and used for themselves the supplies they received in exchange. They also stood firm upon the rule of law, and North Carolina was the only state that never suspended the writ of habeas corpus. Vance would later serve twice as its Governor.

In a final category of "parallels," two figures on opposite sides of the Civil War experienced similar career results, though, technically, one won and the other lost when they met. They also give us more insight into the Battle of Olustee, the largest Civil War conflict in Florida but not so well-known as it should be. It is one of that war's bloodiest encounters.

Brig. Gen. Truman Seymour (1824-1891)

attended Norwich University two years before moving to West Point in 1842; he was graduated in 1846. At the outbreak of the Mexican-American War, he was in the 1st Artillery and was made a first Lieutenant for his meritorious conduct in the Battles of Contreras and Churubusco. After that war, he returned to West Point, where he taught for three years. He had been to Florida before the Battle of Olustee, serving in the Seminole War (1856-1858). When the Civil War began, he was stationed at Fort Sumter and was brevetted Major for his actions there. After recovery from a severe wounding in the charge on Battery Wagner (from Charleston Harbor), he took command of the District of Florida. He saw service in the defense of Washington, became Brigadier General of Volunteers (28 April 1862) and commanded during such battles as Mechanicsville, Malvern Hill, Second Manassas, South Mountain, and Antietam.

A year after the signing of the Emancipation Proclamation (1863), the Yankees came inward from Florida's coast, not just to cut off supply lines to the Confederates and procure outlets for cotton, lumber, and other goods, but to find African-Americans to join their cause. They were also to "inaugurate measures" for returning Florida to the Union. In February 1864, Seymour's division went to Florida and captured Jacksonville.

Seymour took his 5,000 men toward Lake City and met scant resistance until nearing Olustee but was ultimately blocked by Joseph



Finegan's 5200. With Seymour already were three Black regiments, many of whose troops were lost. In fact, at Olustee, of the approximate 11,000 who fought, 2,806 men (1,860 Unionists and 946 Confederates) were killed. The battle lasted some six hours in the woods near Olustee Station and just south of Ocean Pond, a two-mile-wide pond on the edge of Olustee. It is sometimes called the "Battle of Ocean Pond."

After his defeat at Olustee, Seymour retreated to Jacksonville, was relieved of his duty, and became part of the Army of the Potomac. Harper's Pictorial History of The Civil War has correspondence indicating that he "disobeyed orders." In the Battle of the Wilderness, he was captured by Confederates. When he was exchanged, he was put in charge of the Third Division of the VI Corps, led during Union battles in the Shenandoah Valley and during the siege of Petersburg and at Appomattox and was on hand when Lee surrendered to Grant.

The winner at Olustee, Joseph Finegan (1814-1875), did not attend West Point. He had immigrated from Ireland to Florida when he was barely 20, became a farmer and a lawyer,

helped in Florida railroad construction, and was appointed by the Governor to its Secession Convention (1861). He was commissioned a Brigadier General and was in charge of the District of Middle and East Florida.

Finegan sent out a brigade to meet the first of Seymour's forces, who were repulsed. The battle raged, but the Union line finally broke. While notably perspicacious in his tactic of surprise and use of the swamp, Finegan was blamed for not taking advantage of his enemy's retreat and thus allowing most of the Union forces to flee back to Jacksonville. Some three months after Olustee, he was sent to serve with Lee's Army of Northern Virginia.

Both leaders evinced flaws related to Olustee, but so, it is said, did President Lincoln, whose "too sanguine hopes" for the "Florida Expedition" "conducted to the embarrassment of military operations."

We know that war is horrible, but how often do we think of the ravages it serves up to friends, families, and the human spirit in general? Perhaps we should think more deeply about the epithet the "Great Divide" as a fitting assessment of not just the War Between the States but of war in general.

Dr. Lynn Veach Sadler, of Burlington's The Village at Brookwood, a former college president, is widely published in academics and creative writing and works as a writer and an editor. As Central Region Gilbert-Chappell Distinguished Poet 2013-2015, she mentored student and adult poets.

There's a sweet, sweet spirit in this place

by Melody Troncale

Saturday morning, as I walk out my door the aroma of goose berry flowers, damp earth and the cool breeze on my face and arms assails my senses. It is a beautiful morning of blue skies and birds singing. Life is bursting forth in Chatham.

Traveling down 902 towards Bear Creek the morning colors are brilliant with late morning dew. I wave to my friend William, walking to see his niece Ann and her husband Dexter. He lifts his staff and smiles.

William is 88 years old and a native of Chatham. He lives in the family home place. He went to Bonlee School then to Columbia University. He traveled the world and taught school on the Island of New York before coming home to Chatham. He is one of Chatham's crown jewels of love, laughter, kindness and wisdom. We have lunch on occasion; he has been a guiding light for me over the last 28 years in Chatham.

Heading toward Bear Creek I make a detour into the Meroney Church grounds just to see the beautiful church; smile at memories of pot lucks, pork BBQ's, and community float through my mind.

I am on a mission so head for Goldston. The mission is a Saturday morning tradition: "Breakfast at Rufus's Restaurant." There I meet Thurman and Charlotte and various members of their clan. "We have a new baby," her big

brothers are proud. It is blended family of native Chathamites and outlanders who welcome me amid coffee, sausage, eggs, pancakes, and laughter.

After breakfast heading up to Pittsboro two hawks glide in the azure sky and cattle are munching in the cool morning sun. I fear no evil. Green pastures, Chatham County at its finest. An old hymn comes to mind: "there's a sweet, sweet, spirit in this place" and a smile on every face. Gratitude wells within me. A gratitude that would soon be disquieted. Chatham sometimes seems so small. However, I am soon reminded how worldwide Chatham truly is.

Thinking of my list; go by St Bart's to tease Gaines and others at the Community Garden; Chef Geoff at Piedmont Biofarms; St. Bart's needs help with the fund raiser to support the Community Luncheon; the Cora food bank donation. Oh yes, the ATM. Stop, get some cash.

At the grocery store; get to the checkout. Oh no! I left the card in the ATM, how did that happen? (Because now our cards are held hostage by the machine. The new chip is useless most places but on occasions have to give it up. Years of swiping are hard to break.) Blast the new card! Maybe the card is still there. Forgetting the food, I rush back to the ATM. The card is gone.

Now into my glorious day, ominous brooding thoughts don't just threaten my day but have taken over. Where has my gratitude and

serenity gone? What wonderful things has my card bought?

I immediately call the bank; get put on hold. The automated lady can't understand the words: CUSTOMER SERVICE. (I don't know about others but I do not carry my bank account number around).

Starting what seems to be an infinite journey home cell reception is lost three times. Beginning to feel a growl form in my throat. A human finally answers the phone and the card is canceled and I hang up the phone.

Once the card is canceled my phone immediately rings, "Hey Melee, it's Francis. A friend who works with me, his sister, Flower, found your ATM card. He has the card and has asked you call and come get it. Here's his number." Wow! Amazing; the down time of lost card is less than 1.5 hours.

Here is the depth people went to in order to return my card: Flower called her brother; he called Francis; Francis called his mother; friend Lib texted me and told me she gave her son; Francis my phone number. Francis called left a message while I was on hold with the bank.

Meantime waiting for me to answer his message, Francis finds my son, Steve in Spain through Facebook. Steve called left me a message to tell me Francis found my card. The post to Facebook then brought people from all over the county and different parts of the world that

knew one of us in the chain custody to me. They offered solace if I needed help. Awesome!

After looking at all the messages, I call the family that found the card. Speaking with him I find a family originally from outside the US that has settled in Chatham. Pulling into his beautiful neighborhood in Pittsboro, tables are being set up for a dinner party. As I exist my car the man approaches, smile on his face, and hands me the card. I thank him.

"No problem, we are community!" he says. Now the gift of the Chatham Community and its ties into the wide world make me even more grateful. Smiling, I think about caring and community.

The word community comes from communion, which is the sharing or exchanging of intimate thoughts and feelings, especially when the exchange is on a mental or spiritual level.

Thank you Chatham for your "sweet, sweet Spirit!"

Melody Troncale has lived in Chatham County over 29 years. A teacher, artist, and technical analyst, she has worked with numerous non-profits.

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Humane Lobby Day

In May I wrote about the State of NC Animal Advocacy, explaining some of the animal-related bills currently in the North Carolina Legislature. The column also contained information about an upcoming Humane Lobby Day. It was held on June 7, 2016 at North Carolina Legislative Building in Raleigh.

Over a hundred people from all over the state attended Humane Lobby Day; two from Chatham County. The day consisted of various speakers, a presentation of awards to animal welfare youth leaders, networking with other attendees, and appointments to meet with our local House and Senate Representatives. I found the day to be very educational, especially in respect to process of what happens to bills in the legislature.

The keynote speaker was Dr. David Jones, retired Director of the North Carolina Zoo. He spoke about a NC-based program he started four years ago called Wild Welfare. The purpose of this organization is to improve the lives of captive wild animals. There are more than 10,000 zoos in the world. Most of them provide substandard care for their animals; including a large number of zoos in America. In most cases the animal caretakers lack basic knowledge on the needs of the animals under their supervision. Wild Welfare provides education and information through the American Zoo Association, assisting a number of zoos in getting on the right track. More information on Wild Welfare can be found at: www.nczoo.com/ConservationAnimals/Wild_Welfare.

During Humane Lobby Day, State Representatives met with the constituents from their districts to discuss bills that had already passed in the House and now resided with the Senate. These bills were HB 554, Protect Public from Dangerous Wild Animals, (making it illegal to own exotic wild animals) and HB 159: Dog Breeder Standards (requires basic care for dog breeding operations). House Representative Robert Reives (Chatham and Lee) and Senate Representative Valerie Foushee (Chatham and



Contact your Representatives directly about HB554 and HB159.
www.ncga.state.nc.us

Orange) were very helpful, professional, and friendly. Rep. Reives already voted to pass these bills. Rep. Foushee has not had an opportunity to vote on them, but appeared to be on-board for the bills to pass. Unfortunately, neither bill will likely make any progress this session, as both have been placed in committees that rarely meet.

HB 554, Protect Public from Dangerous Wild Animals was moved to the Rules and Operations Committee. This committee happened to have met on the day of the Humane Lobby event, but no action taken on this bill. The committee chairperson is Senate Representative Tom Apodaca (Buncombe, Henderson, and Transylvania).

HB 159, Dog Breeder Standards was initially moved to the Ways and Means Committee. We were told this committee hasn't met in five years. Then the bill was described as being "parked" in the Redistricting Committee, where Senate Representative Bob Rucho (Mecklenberg) is the chairperson. This committee last met in July 2015 and according to the North Carolina General Assembly website, has no future meetings scheduled.

Committee chairpersons ultimately call meetings and set agendas as to which bills to work on. The House passed these bills with votes of 107/5 (HB 554) and 87/27 (HB 159). At

this time, it appears Chairmen Apodaca and Rucho hold the power as to whether these bills go anywhere anytime soon.

One of the speakers at Humane Lobby Day talked about how we sometimes receive petitions to sign via email or Facebook that will be forwarded to the legislature on behalf of a particular issue. She went on to say it is much more impactful on the representatives to be contacted directly. The chairmen of the committees where HB 554 and HB 159 are "parked" need to hear from the public who want to see these bills passed. The NC General Assembly website contains mailing addresses, phone numbers, and email addresses for all state representatives. Members of all committees can be found on the website, as well. Go to: www.ncga.state.nc.us Bills can also be read here.

It seems the NC Senate politicians are passing more anti-animal welfare legislation and stalling pro-animal welfare bills. HB 554, Protect Public from Dangerous Wild Animals was sponsored by House Representatives Chuck McGrady, Pat Hurley, Jon Hardister, and Jason Saine. HB 159, Dog Breeder Standards was sponsored by House Representatives Chuck McGrady, Jason Saine, Pricey Harrison, and Rick Catlin. It might be nice for them to receive words of appreciation for what they have done in working to improve the lives of so many animals in this state.

Most people agree on humane treatment for animals. However, when there are opportunities to do something that can lead to improvements, only a few typically show up. Sometimes, a few is all it takes to make a difference, but there is definitely power in numbers. In most cases, working for change is a marathon, not a sprint. Whether in a town, county, or state, we can be the voice for those who cannot speak.

Valerie Broadway, the Canine Coach, is a dog trainer and behavioral specialist. For information: 919.542.4726 or www.caninecoachingservices.com

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This summer will continue to be very busy for Chatham Park. We have moved into our new, onsite headquarters (pictured below) and we’ll soon complete a second medical office building, the bridge over the US-64 Bypass, and the first UNC Hospice Center in Chatham County.

These projects represent new jobs and new services for the community, an enhanced tax base for the Town of Pittsboro and Chatham County, and millions of dollars of investment into the local economy.

As Chatham Park moves forward, we will continue to provide answers to questions received from members of the community.

Chatham Park has compiled a list of Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ’s). Here are eight general questions we are frequently asked and the answers.



Q: When was the first Chatham Park land acquisition?

A: The first tract of land for Chatham Park was acquired in January of 2006.

Q: How big will Chatham Park be?

A: At final build out, Chatham Park will cover approximately 7,068 acres. In addition, Chatham Park currently owns over 1,000 acres that are adjacent to the currently approved master planned development.

Q: When will Chatham Park begin development and construction?

A: Construction began in September of 2014 with the groundbreaking for the UNC Medical Office Building. In April of 2016 the first building received its certificate of occupancy and our headquarters received its certificate of occupancy in June of 2016.

Q: What is the current zoning for Chatham Park?

A: Chatham Park is currently zoned as a Planned Development District (PDD) that will include 22,000 residential units and 22 million square feet of non-residential space.

Q: Will Chatham Park include a solar farm?

A: Yes, Strata Solar currently has a lease for a twenty (20) mega watt solar farm.

Q: Will Chatham Park use reclaimed water?

A: Yes, Chatham Park will be the first community in Chatham County to install reuse water lines (purple pipe) throughout the entire project. The purple pipe will provide a source of water for irrigation and for cooling in commercial buildings.

Q: When is Chatham Park expected to reach maximum buildout?

A: The entire Chatham Park project is expected to reach completion in approximately 40 years.

Q: What will the project cost?

A: Chatham Park will cost over \$15 billion. Infrastructure costs will be approximately \$1.8 billion (not including land value) over 35 years, with operation costs of \$250 million over that same time frame. Chatham Park will pay for construction, water lines, infrastructure, etc., for the development. No tax dollars will be directly used to help build the development.

New home, new Board Members for Chatham Arts Council

by Lesley L. Landis

In the last two years, the Chatham Arts Council has introduced a new logo, new brand, new mission focus, and new website. But there's more! In February, the agency moved into a new location while continuing to strengthen their presence in the county through programs that "invest in artists and educate kids through the arts". Recently, the Arts Council hosted an Open House and Annual Meeting which highlighted the variety of arts experiences the agency provides to the county.

On a recent Sunday afternoon, a bright "multi-colored carpet" of chalk led to the Council's new office at 118 West Street in the county seat of Pittsboro. Current and former board members, artists, donors, educators, and friends from across the county walked through a kaleidoscope of bubbles and ClydeFEST T-shirts and games on the front yard. Visitors toured the council's new space and learned about the activities of the council working to "nurture creative minds."

The pilot year of the Chatham Artists-in-Schools Initiative was a big focus of the day. In the center hallway, a gallery of photographs captured artist residencies at local schools. Students, teachers, and administrators from Virginia Cross Elementary, North Chatham Elementary, Moncure, SAGE Academy, Bonlee Elementary and J.S. Waters Elementary schools benefitted from a variety of performances, professional development, and school work that enhanced the curriculum. Cheryl Chamblee, Executive Director of the Chatham Arts Council shared moving stories of the impacts felt by students and educators during and following the residencies which were made possible by collaborations between Chatham Arts Council and the NC Arts Council, Chatham County, Chatham County Schools, Chatham Park Investors, Chatham Homes Realty and individual donors.

"The arts council has put several years of preparation into our Artists-in-Schools initiative, both as a vehicle for the arts to have a meaningful impact on our students and as a program

CLYDEFEST

This year's ClydeFEST is slated for Saturday, September 24th in Bynum. This hands-on arts festival designed especially for children 2-10 years of age includes original, custom games inspired by Mr. Jones' critters, live music, food trucks, and guests such as jump rope phenoms the Bouncing Bulldogs, hula hoopers, stilt walkers, clowns, dancers, and more. The day always concludes with a critter making demonstration and a raffle — along with a few tears because it's over. Folks wishing to volunteer are encouraged to sign up at the Arts Council website, www.chathamartscouncil.org



that can have the widest reach in this large county." said Gina Harrison, board chair. "The Arts Council is thrilled to be working with such distinguished teaching artists as Mike Wiley, EbzB Productions, Shabutaso, and Geraud Staton, and with the dedicated, creative educators in the Chatham County Schools system." Harrison added, "This is the beginning of a dynamic collaboration that can grow every year."

For 15 years, the organization has presented their signature event, which deserved its own area in the ClydeFEST Room. Brightly colored photos of smiling youngsters showed highlights from this unique, place-based "kids carnival of folk art fun" while decorative, sculptural "critters" made from wood and found objects such as bottle caps, tennis balls, plastic flowers and lots of glitter by the festival's namesake Clyde Jones, stood watch.

Providing music for the Open House and Annual Meeting were Northwood High School students Hudson Moore and Haley Poythress. Joey Howell followed on guitar. Enjoying the music and food were local theatre artist Serena Ebhardt, and visual artists Onicas Gaddis, Marcelle Pachnowski, and Diane DeBardeleben. Performing artist Victoria Chall joined the crowd as did author, educator, and creativity coach Michele Berger, among many others.

All the visitors participated in an election of new board members. As a result, the council is eager to welcome to the board Selbe Bartlett, a resident of Moncure and vice-president with AllScripts who manages international teams and focuses on strategic planning and financial management; Elisabeth Lewis Corley an award-winning poet, and a producer, actor, director, screenwriter for film and stage, who founded the Atlanta Shakespeare Company; Jon Spoon who currently serves as the Small Business Center Director for Chatham County where he assists potential entrepreneurs and existing small business owners, and Sue Szary a textile artist and business owner of Twin Birch Products and against his will studio in Siler City. These four new members will begin their terms at the first meeting of the board in July.

To learn more, volunteer, or donate to the Chatham Arts Council, please visit our website at www.ChathamArtsCouncil.org or contact a board member.

Lesley L. Landis is the Board Secretary of the Chatham Arts Council

Cut flowers feel like home

After 10 hours in the car, we could hardly growl at each other. Honestly, we did quite well traveling this long distance until the last "pile up" 15 minutes from our destination ... Jacksonville, Florida. We took our second detour of the day and arrived at the cottage in early evening to be greeted by my nephew and niece-in-law.

They walked us around their cottage sharing the quirks with us and then said, "It is all yours for the week. Enjoy!" As they were turning to leave, I noticed an enormous arrangement of mixed colored hydrangeas on the kitchen table. My niece just beamed as she said, "Picked fresh from my garden. Imagine." Being a non-gardener herself, this was such a gift from her to me. She instinctively knew that flowers would really make me feel at home and garden flowers would just touch my heart. I

In the Garden

by Ginny Gregory



felt so loved. Ah! Time to relax.

Our beach stay was filled with hunting for shark teeth, diving and charging in and out of the ocean, marveling at schools of flying fish, dolphins and a few manatees. We saw a baby skink and several turtle nests with tracks leading from the ocean up to a nest. There was a new sighting of something each day and the calmest sea I have ever experienced.

We read books, walked in the early morning and late evening was filled with my Isaac

learning to ride a bike. Everyone out for evening strolls cheered him on and his victory shone as he did his last ride peddling up the driveway to the cottage. He was feeling so proud!

When I was Isaac's age, my mother used to get up early during our beach trips and quickly get ready for the beach alone. With "bathing cap" solidly in place decked out in her long skirted bathing suit she would begin her solid steady strokes across the calm daybreak ocean. This was her quiet connection with sea.

She had very fair skin ("red head ginger bread five cents a cabbage head" was a taunt that followed her always as a child), consequently she came out in her private fashion garb. She wore light blue peddle pushers, a long sleeve white shirt, socks, Keds and always a big brimmed hat. She would sit under an umbrella rented from the pier and watch the endless waves soothing her soul ... eyes always locked out to sea. We certainly shared the love of the ocean together.

Back in Jacksonville, we all clung to the door frame as we forced ourselves to climb back into the car to begin our long trek. We had one last "hunt walk", did linens so our kin would think us civilized and finally headed north to reclaim North Carolina as home.

After a week of being surrounded by so much unusual nature, the car was like being vacuum packed into the tube that sends our checks/money into the bank and then sucked back into real time. I have always found both the transition to and from vacation to be very painful. It takes me forever to empty out my

brain and eons to charge back up for the next workday.

Finally home, with the car unpacked I began to walk around the house just relishing being home with happy puppies leaping around my feet and then my eye caught a massive vase of the same hydrangeas I just left at the coast. Impossible! Lizzie had been pruning some of the hydrangeas and put together the most beautiful present of garden lusciousness. I simply melted inside. There is nothing like home.

The spring rains helped make this happen. Last year I barely had a decent handful of these wonderful flowers. Nothing increases yield like glorious rain. Today was the best for gardening. We had low 80's and a slight breeze. I weeded and planted a few late entries into the garden quilt. I was sweaty to the bone and a glass of iced water never tasted so good!

Without nature surrounding me, I would expire. Cut flowers have always been a family tradition filled with love. As company comes and family stays, flowers are always set out to greet all who come to Blue Moon. I learned this from my dear grandmother and my mother. They both instinctively knew that nature is the best welcome.

Hunker down for the hot months ahead of us. Enjoy your garden in the cool of the early morning. Each day brings a new beginning. Seize the day.

Ginny Gregory is a life-long gardener. She is the owner and creative energy behind Beyond The Pail...Creating Gardens and Beyond. beyondthecrate@gmail.com



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No man is an island

“No man is an island, Entire of itself, Every man is a piece of the continent, A part of the main. If a clot be washed away by the sea, Europe is the less... Any man’s death diminishes me, because I am involved in mankind, and therefore never send to know for whom the bell tolls, It tolls for thee.”

John Donne published these words in 1624 as a devotional meditation. Now 392 years later, these words ring through our minds and hearts. These words are important for all of us to meditate upon. John Donne’s life reflects both love and tragedy in his poetry handed down to us over the years. Religion was always an important theme in Donne’s life and writing. Donne’s themes, the love of family and mankind, the stress, turmoil and tragedies in human life as well as religious suffering can still be found in modern day 2016!

This article is not really about John Donne, but I will say a few words about his life and works. At age 4, Donne’s father died, his mother remarried and two of his sisters died several years thereafter. The family was a reclusive Roman Catholic family when that religion was illegal in England. Donne did indulge in some of the usual passions of youth, settling down later. During his early years Donne and his family experienced difficulty in their religious faith. Donne’s brother was arrested for harboring a Catholic priest. This priest was tortured and killed by the authorities while Donne’s brother died in prison. Preparing for a diplomatic career, Donne fell in love and married against the wishes of her family. His wife Ann birthed 12 children in their 16 years of marriage including two stillborn children, dying herself several days after the last baby. Donne mourned her loss deeply, living himself 14 years thereafter, losing another child during that time and suffering health problems. He was honored to be named Dean of Saint Paul’s Cathedral in the Church of England for his last 10 years of life during which he wrote this poem in a series of meditations and prayers on pain, health and sickness published under the title Devotions upon Emergent Occasions. Religion became increasingly important in his life and literary career, focusing on sermons and religious poems. Donne began to challenge death with his belief in eternal life in heaven.

Donne was a prolific writer with poetry, elegies, verse letters, songs and sonnets and other writings now published in many scholarly books. The memories of Donne’s words echo in Ernest Hemingway’s “For Whom The Bell Tolls”, William Styron’s “Set This House on Fire” and Thomas Merton’s “No Man is An Island.” His influence can be found in popular culture; for example Van Morrison’s song “Rave On John Donne.” References to Donne’s “Death Be Not Proud” and “No Man Is An Island” can be found throughout our culture.

Donne’s words are beautiful and inspiring, surviving throughout the ages and as a part of many spiritual and religious practices. We are taught that all people are connected upon this earth and in the heavenly realms. But do you actually know this? Do you ever think about this? Yes, the purpose of this article is for me to impart some information to you about Donne and his work. But , most important, my goal is also to inspire you to think about these issues, take them into your heart, and begin to live as the interconnected beings that you really are. These days especially it seems that people spend a lot of time ostensibly communicating without really communicating. Out to dinner at a beautiful restaurant recently, I observed the people at the next table talking to each other occasionally, but mostly texting separately. Texting, twittering, facebooking; do these activities really serve the purpose of communication or are they mainly self indulgent activities? People these days often act as if they are isolated “islands” lost in a disjointed world. Donne tells us differently. Think about the fact that the world includes more than people in our country, more than people in the world; it also includes all of nature, animals, creatures of the sea, trees and plants, all developed and programmed to live together in the beautiful symphony of life. In the heavens we can find angels, beautiful spirits, a heavenly home for our loved ones, and a positive destination for us when we shed our bodies and follow our hearts back to our eternal lives. But do YOU see this world harmony happening around you or do you live in a boxlike house, drive around in a metal car, spend your life with gadgets and forget about the greater good? Apparently going

Advice Line

By Dr. Betty Phillips





to church is not enough. One morning I turned on the TV to hear a prominent cleric talking to an audience of people clasping Bibles. I was about to change the channel when I heard him negate the idea of “good works.” Good works are prosocial behaviors which help people other than yourself. Disparaging the idea of good works, he cited the importance of church attendance and financial support of church activities.

Spiritual and religious people as well as social scientists appear concerned about the lack of real, heartfelt social understanding and communication. Others follow the writings of Ayn Rand. In her novel “Atlas Shrugged”, Rand developed a theme that human nature is fundamentally selfish, that “each man exists for his own sake, and the achievement of his own happiness is his highest moral purpose.” Admirers of this work include the influential politician, Paul Ryan, who cites the book as one of his main inspirations for entering politics and is known to give copies of this book to interns and admirers. Interestingly enough, before children are old enough to read Ayn Rand, toddlers show frequent examples of helpful behavior toward others and contagion between feelings. I wonder and worry if these children’s natural prosocial behaviors will be negatively influenced by the increasing influence of screen time on their lives.

Think deeply about the concept that “No man is an island.” Please take these issues into your heart as you consider them in your mind, and then begin to add helpful prosocial altruistic behaviors into your life. You will find an increase in love and happiness in your own life as you open up to the world around you. Consider the Loving Kindness meditation. In this meditation you will bring love and happiness to yourself (as the key person in your world), your loved ones, your acquaintances, individuals who are difficult to deal with, and then a final perspective on the interconnected nature of all mankind. Once you begin this practice, you can fit it into your daily activities without spending a great deal of time on this meditation. The benefits will far outweigh the time you’ve spent. I am not a great meditator, but I was able to incorporate this beautiful meditation into my daily life for a year and a half with wonderful results. For more information about this meditation, I’ve included articles in the Reading Room section of my website “Loving Kindness Meditation Update” (<http://www.bettyphillipspsychology.com/id125.html>.)

An important issue in our society concerns money and finances. It is clear that most of us need an adequate amount of money and possessions to live in this society. It is also increasingly clear that wealth is being concentrated into a very small percent of people while increasing numbers of us have to work long hours for inadequate support especially for families, young people and children. Today you see evidence of political revolutions all around us as these issues become increasingly clear and problematic.

Scripture and spiritual contacts provide evidence of the right of all individuals and families to have adequate life support. “Give us this day our daily bread” is promised. “The Lord is our shepherd; we shall not want.” Spiritual works and writings assure us that divine intervention intends that all individuals have adequate support for themselves and their families. Increasingly the rich and wealthy are becoming conspicuous consumers as well as misers of their possessions. If you look on the Internet you will find many articles about the fact that the rich are very selfish. According to the author Steve Siebold, “They’re selfish and they are okay with it. Rich people think selfishness is a virtue.” What happened to altruism and sharing? Psychologists know that hoarders of wealth actually begin to lead lives of negativity and depression, while adequate life support provides joy and happiness to individuals who share their daily bread.

In thinking about this issue, don’t forget Donne’s words: when “the Bell tolls, it tolls

for thee.” We will ALL face a transition from this life into eternal life. Some people may not believe this outcome will apply to them, but eternal laws do apply to all of us. So-called “resting in peace in a grave” does not seem a particularly desirable outcome to me. This life is but a small part of time, and time is eternal. I don’t raise this issue to increase anxiety and fear. I raise this issue to stress the importance

of a life well spent sharing happiness and love throughout the world with all beings. It is true that “No Man Is An Island!”

Need Advice? Send Dr. Betty Phillips questions about individual, relationship, marriage or family issues to BettyPhillips@BellSouth.net or 466 Eagle Point Road, Pittsboro 27312. Questions can be anonymous. Betty looks forward to hearing from you!

Infinite Sky: (Part 8 of 10)

by Gregory Louie

Dear gentle readers,

Give yourself a treat and take a break from your busy life.

Wherever you are, you can take a short mini-vacation. How? Just take a deep breath in, close your eyes for a moment, relax and then let the air fall out of your mouth. Repeat. Each time you do so let your shoulders go and feel your chest drop. Slow your breath down and take time to stay in the feeling of relaxation. You may find a feeling of well-being, so stay a little longer... A smile may appear on your face and then a sensation may bubble up from within filling you with joy. Do this as long as want your mini-vacation to last.

Life lived this way can be as simple as taking a breath. And in contrast, life can be as complex as only you can really know. As a meditator, it becomes a matter of choice. The more practiced you become, the more it becomes your choice. Even when there seems to be no choice.

This reminds me of a short story. A lone hunter realizes that he is being stalked and starts to run for his life. He comes to a cliff and has to quickly climb down on a vine to avoid being killed by a tiger. Looking up he sees the tiger pacing back and forth licking his chops. Looking below, he sees certain death. A mouse suddenly appears on a ledge above just out of his reach and starts to gnaw on the vine. Out of the corner of his eyes, he sees a ripe wild strawberry. He plucks it, pops it in his mouth and says, “How sweet!”

In our modern lives, sometimes we may feel like that hunter, stuck in an impossible situation. If we can remember to take a deep breath in, closing our eyes and feel the pleasure of well-being, we too, like the hunter can find in each moment, there is the possibility of tasting the sweetness of being alive. So why not close your eyes now and take a deep breath? I wish you all the best in your journey!

Gregory Louie is an experienced meditator and taiji practitioner. He can be reached at gregory.louie@gmail.com



Mark Hewitt



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Local flora keep you cool in summer

by Will Endres

It is with great relish that I experience the intensity of our hot, humid Piedmont summers. Teaching people how to be cool, refreshed, and comfortable outdoors despite the heat is the ‘hot topic’ in my classes during this peak of flowering flora. Empowering them to thoroughly enjoy themselves outside gives me great pleasure, and we are fortunate that nature shares a variety of gifted plants that are equipped with different talents for cooling us.

Especially perfect for this time are the sour “lemonade” drinks readily available from a variety of local, and native plants. Easily accessible natural areas abound here, meaning most of us can find such lemony plants as Wood Sorrel, Sourwood Tree leaves, and the Yellow-Flowered Sourgrass. These plants are collectively members of a category known as “Refrigerants”, a term used by herbalists to describe herbs that have natural cooling properties. While all of these plants can be enjoyed in a variety of ways, ranging from nibbles, salads and fluid extracts, my personal favorite is to use Wood Sorrel in a simple infusion. After gathering the leaves, I steep it in water in a tightly lidded container either as a sun infusion or boiling the water first. The resulting infusion is a beautiful, pale, “pink lemonade” color and to many pallets, it needs no additional sweetening. These plants are so common and tasty that it’s a shame anyone would bother to go buy chemical lemonade from the store.

At this time of year, we make an effort to stay in the shade. Often, we find ourselves on the banks of one of our many mighty rivers, such as the Eno, the Rocky, or the Haw. We go slower now, taking time to dip our feet in the water, and often swim; discussing our neighboring aquatic plants, and their surrounding communities.

In addition to the cool, shady forests, there is something else we must embrace this time of year: perspiration. Something that many people don’t realize is that you can harness the power of your body’s natural cooling system, without roasting yourself in the southern sun simply by stimulating perspiration. There are many plants that can help us take advantage of this. Two of the best are the ever-popular Elder shrub, and Yarrow.

Like many plants, these two tend to show



Yellow Wood Sorrel, above and Edler flowers, below.



up when they are needed most. We are now in the midst of gathering the beautiful, creamy Elder flowers in preparation for extraction. Most often, we search for Elder, which happens to be one of my favorite shrubs, on the banks of pure, sunny streams. In fact, if you have a wet, open, sunny space in your yard, it is quite easy to grow, and may even be present already. In Europe, Elder is one of the most popular herbal remedies for flu, and the common cold. We also use the softly fragrant flowers as a wonderful, mild tea that is good for encouraging light perspiration.

Likewise, our friend Yarrow is also just beginning to bloom here in the Piedmont. It is a wonderful, although slightly stronger, diuretic that can be made into a tasty tea if made on the weaker side. In addition to its cooling properties, it does a fine job of treating allergies, tonifying the liver, and stopping external bleeding, as well as excessive menstrual flow.

All of these extracts are available Saturday at our downtown Durham and Carborro farmers’ market booths or online. We would love to hear about your experiences with them, or the hot weather they help us cope with!

Will Endres is an herbalist, wild crafter, and outdoor guide with a lifetime of experience. He has had many herbal elders, and has been deeply influenced by the traditional Cherokee approach to plants and medicine. He has taught over 476 apprentices, and countless community members, about the bounty of wild plants in the Piedmont.

If you’re interested in learning about useful plants and trees, the seven-week Foraging and Exploration class runs Tuesday 10 a.m.–2 p.m. from July 12 through August 23 in the Hillsborough area. The Central Carolina Community College Foraging and Exploration class at the Pittsboro Campus runs for eight weeks on Wednesdays at 9 a.m.–4:30 p.m. from October 11 through December 8. Please register though the college at www.cccc.edu/ecd or call 919.718.7500. Contact Will at 919.451.6643, or email him at willswildherbs@gmail.com. You can also visit his webpage at www.willswildherbs.org, his Facebook, or Instagram accounts as well.

CHANGE

CONTINUED FROM PAGE 1

Lake. It is also carrying dissolved toxins that are found in Pittsboro drinking water, especially after a heavy rain. There is hope. There are positive signs. I often see eagles, osprey, otters, great blue herons, king fishers, egrets and green herons. Fishing is good, although I would not recommend that you eat the fish you catch since the toxins mentioned above bioaccumulate in their tissue; i.e., toxins increase in concentration in fish because of the things they eat that accumulate the toxins from the things they eat and so on and so on.

Fortunately, some upriver sewage treatment plants are being upgraded. Efforts are underway to keep river buffers safe from logging and urban encroachment. As coal-fired power

plants are mothballed, there will be a reduction of mercury which makes most fish caught in the eastern United States unsafe to eat on a regular basis. The Haw River Trail, both land and river, is raising public consciousness by creating recreational opportunities for those who did not previously have legal access to the river. Organizations like the Haw River Assembly continue to provide outreach and environmental education. In general, the public is more aware of the problems of pollution and loss of habitat. Hopefully, this awareness will influence our political leaders through the electoral process. Things are getting better.

You see, to make things better you have to “try” to be the change you wish to see in the world. Things are better for the Haw River because people during the past 40+ years “tried” to make a difference in what they saw as a negative situation. They didn’t wait for someone-else to make the difference. What

they found out was that they were not alone in changing the world. There were others that saw the same negative situation and made an effort to make things better. In fact, many of those same people have not given up because there is still a lot of work to do to return the Haw River and all of life that depends on it to the condition that existed before we humans started dominating the landscape.

Be the change you wish to see in the world. What would that mean to you? What are you passionate about? Where do you go to escape the insanity of the world? What one thing will you do while on this earth to make a difference and help change things for the better? Be the change. The world needs you.

Joe Jacob, a Chatham resident for more than 30 years and a marine biologist by training, is president The Haw River Canoe & Kayak Co., www.hawrivercanoe.com, 336.260.6465. He worked for The Nature Conservancy for 20 years and served as Director of Science for TNC’s Southeast Region.



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Poison Ivy — a horrifying and whimsical plant

by Michael Pollock

Poison ivy is a fearsome and capricious dragon in the woods. Sometimes I can walk through it and nothing happens, other times I'll be afflicted and in pain for at least a week. A few years ago I was trimming a seemingly poison ivy free area in a state park, and I couldn't understand how my legs got painful blisters. I must have mown over dead leaves under an inconspicuous vine and been peppered with pulverized bits soaked with poisonous urushiol. Alarmingly, I kept getting re-exposed in the same spots, even though I soaked my work jeans in soapy water for hours, maybe even a day at a time. I wore the same clothes all year, but it only happened in the summer, so I'm wondering if sweat wicked out lingering urushiol. Or maybe the hot weather opened my pores and let leftover urushiol in. Eventually the problem subsided, but I'm still suspicious of those jeans. Reportedly dry cleaning can purify contaminated clothes and even rubber gloves don't stop urushiol. Urushiol sensitivity takes repeated exposures to develop, and can become more severe, though it might alleviate.

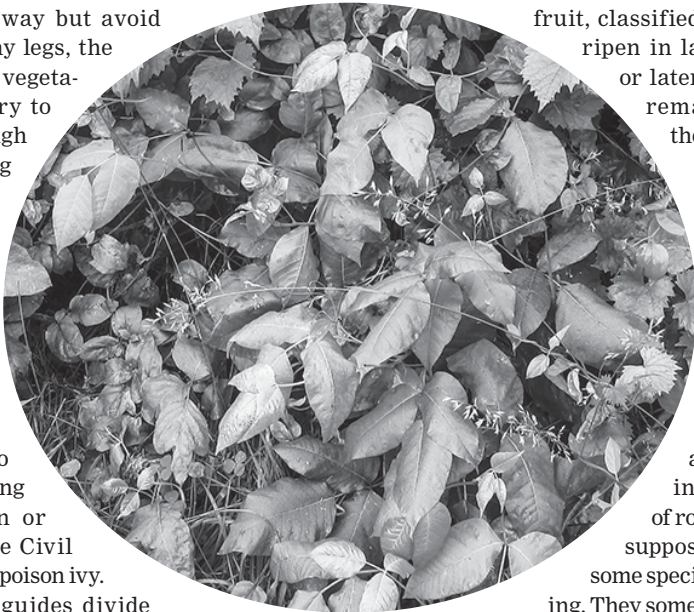
Both poison ivy plants and the contact dermatitis they cause vary in appearance. In elementary school I got large blisters between my fingers, though I thought I avoided it. Now I get single blisters, rashes of small blisters (which tend to merge), and whimsical tracings, mainly on my legs. It seems like poison ivy causes large, hard blisters on extremities but bumps elsewhere. At the state park I got isolated blisters, which would usually be minor, but I couldn't wash off easily, so intense yellow blisters would rapidly and painfully swell all day and become very large later. This left very faint red circles that seem to go away after one or a few years, though I wonder if this redness is lasting longer than it used to, even just years ago. For me, the blisters ache and sting as they rise, and become itchy when they dry out and flake, and then I have to be careful not to itch until I bleed. Initial itching seems to raise blisters.

Poison ivy seems most potent around now and harmless in winter, but even stems and roots contain urushiol. I wear shorts in the

woods anyway but avoid touching my legs, the ground, or vegetation, and try to wade through water along the way and wash with soap as soon as I get home, even if I think I avoided the leaves. I shudder to imagine being on the run or fighting the Civil War amidst poison ivy.

Online guides divide poison ivy into Eastern and Western species (*Toxicodendron radicans* and *T. rydbergii*), both of which apparently grow in North Carolina, as does a similar plant, Atlantic or Eastern poison oak (*T. pubescens*); Pacific poison oak doesn't grow here. These plants are very similar and some can hybridize, so this division seems questionable. Apparently only Eastern poison ivy can be a vine or liana, but they all have leaves composed of leaflets that are spindle-shaped, often with one or more notches or lobes, not necessarily identical on all of the leaflets composing the trifoliate or ternately compound leaf. The middle leaflet has a longer stalk. Fresh leaves often shine. The old Manual of the Vascular Flora of the Carolinas only distinguishes poison ivy and poison oak, and the main difference is that poison ivy leaves might have hairs on the veins underneath while poison oak leaves tend to be oak-shaped and hairy on both sides, but mostly underneath, and it has hairier fruit.

After leafing, these plants produce clusters of tiny greenish flowers, possibly flowering twice in a year. Apparently Eastern poison ivy tends to have more than 25 flowers per cluster while Western poison ivy has fewer. Many insects can visit, and poison ivy is said to produce good honey. The whitish



fruit, classified as drupes, ripen in late summer or later and might remain during the winter.

These plants have spreading red rhizomes and poison ivy can cling to trees as a vine, usually covered in a dark fur of roots, and it is supposed to prefer some species for climbing. They somewhat resemble unrelated Virginia creeper and English ivy. Vines with numerous long horizontal branches look like trees, something to watch out for when camping. Poison ivy can display fiery fall colors, but it is usually small and muddled.

These plants are nearly ubiquitous and can be found in temporary swamps, fields, and dry roadsides and benefit from human disturbance of shady woodlands. Reportedly Eastern poison ivy can grow in more acidic soil than Western poison ivy, and both tolerate salt. Research at Duke shows that increasing CO2 is making poison ivy more luxuriant and potent.

Poison sumac is a small tree found in wet areas that has pinnately compound leaves and white berries and could be the most poisonous of all. I have a morbid curiosity about what that actually means, but it might be best if I never come across one. Its sap turns black on contact with the air and can be used for lacquer. The term urushiol comes from the Japanese name for the related lacquer tree. Toxicodendrons are in the cashew family, but I can eat store-bought cashews and drink "lemonade" made with red sumac fruit.

Very few animals are afflicted by poison ivy. Livestock eat it, as do deer, muskrats, rabbits, groundhogs, squirrels, mice, foxes, bears, and a few moths, like showy emeralds and fluid arches. Seventy-five or more birds eat the fruit, especially turkeys and bobwhites. A recent episode of Nature showed a Japanese macaque sitting in a bed of three-leafed plants, eating the leaves (!), and that might have been the East Asian variety of poison ivy. Frequently poison ivy leaves have their own blisters.

If it weren't so dangerous, poison ivy would be a good groundcover. Amazingly, it is supposed to have been introduced in Europe, Africa, Australia, and New Zealand for its fall color, and has been studied for land reclamation. Reportedly the sap was used to label linens and in shoe varnish. Poison ivy was introduced to the UK in 1640, and in 1798 a man's six-year "herpetic eruption" went away after accidental exposure. Afterward, it was used medically for that and other "eruptive" skin diseases, palsy, paralysis, rheumatism, arthritis, liver problems, urinary incontinence, and as a sedative. Possibly it would reverse vitiligo. In homeopathy it was used for skin problems (especially from nettle), ringworm, and rheumatism.

Sticky urushiol released by damaged plants has to be washed off with water (the medical advice is to use cold water) and/or rubbing alcohol and can spread through wash water, though I'm not sure I've seen this. Pets and objects can spread it, and inhaling urushiol-laced smoke is potentially fatal. Weeping blisters are harmless, but can get infected. Scarring is a risk with facial exposure. Sometimes I apply hydrocortisone cream, but otherwise I let dermatitis run its course. Scalding water relieves pain and even causes a good feeling to run through my whole body, and this only happens with poison ivy blistering.

Michael Pollock is a freelance writer living in southern Durham who started Northeast Creek Stream Watch (www.northeastcreek.org) He studied biology and anthropology at UNC.

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House Bill 2.

by amanda ashley

I have been trying for over a month to find the appropriate words to convey the horrors of this odious legislation which is House Bill 2: to list and condemn its codification of discrimination against not only members of the LGBTQ community but also against veterans, women, the elderly, the handicapped, and just about anyone except healthy and wealthy white men. Yet each time I find myself on track to write the proper sentiments, some new national foolishness bursts forth which can be directly traced to the hatred embedded within and engendered by HB2. Assaults in public restrooms against women who do not fit an arbitrary image of what a woman should look like. Calls from church pulpits to castigate others whom congregants were previously unaware of and comfortable with. Politicians riding imaginary fears of discredited phantom events to election victories they do not deserve. The increase in similar legislative hate-bills introduced in other states. It has been hard to get a bead on this un-needed new law.

And now the tragedy in Orlando intrudes makes the social landscape under which House Bill 2 was created even more sickening.

For this is where we find ourselves, in a nightclub-turned-warzone, when the bread-crumbs of hatred drop into the public arena from the minds of empty-hearted men holding political sway. We are turned against each other, divided against ourselves, used by craven and cowardly politicians exploiting

both our innocence and fears to do nothing but enhance their own personal power. And this is the true essence of HB2: the aggrandizement of power to men who care nothing about anyone except themselves. While the political does frame HB2, we must look behind the political to discern the visceral disdain the extremist Republicans within the current North Carolina General Assembly and governorship hold for all citizens of North Carolina. We are being used; especially those traditional conservative voters who think this is their father's or grandfather's traditional Republican Party. It is not. This Republican Party wants your children's schools starved of funding. This GOP raises your taxes bit by little bit so you don't notice. (How many readers here have actually owed NC state taxes for the very first time ever, during the past two years?) This Republican Party turns its back on the veterans it urged and coerced into an endless war with no point or purpose. This Republican Party hides from you the poisons in your well-water resulting from oil and gas fracking for which there is zero market. This Republican Party would deny you your day in court if your employer terminates you because they simply don't like who you are.

This Republican Party hates you. All of you. If you think it does not, and support the provisions of HB2 because you are not transgender or lesbian or gay, think again; for you have fallen for the scarecrow's charms, and pity to you that you have been so deceived. They counted on that. The old "Look over there!" while they pick your pockets here has been most effective.

North Carolina is now merely the latest in the list of States which have been hoodwinked by extremist Republicans. Wisconsin has been economically wrecked. Kansas has been fiscally ransacked. Arizona and Texas made laughingstocks around the world for suppression of civil liberties. Louisiana and Florida environmentally imperiled by those who place profit before science. Our North Carolina was recently in the forefront of intelligent governance which recognized that a vital role of the State is to promote the well-being of all, rather than the eradication of the structures which make that possible. No longer. The extremist Republican agenda is slowly but surely eroding gains which benefited those in agriculture, in the educational sector, in the tourism industry, in the promotion of local governmental autonomy, in the availability to all citizens judicial review of perceived injustices. Well, you can now kiss all of that good-bye, while trying to imagine just what sort of future these callous extremists have in mind and store.

One should summon some sort of existential sympathy for the conservative voters who support and enable politicians who so clearly intend to delude and defraud the very people who elect them. Voting against "one's own best interest" has become a tactic used well by extremist Republicans. House Bill 2, a terribly crafted piece of legislative work, excellently serves that role.

While on the surface it bashes the strange transmen and transwomen to ostensibly protect our children (a nasty and un-necessary unconstitutional intrusion in and of itself), it quietly opens the door for discrimination

against all. That is what HB2 actually does. Should, for example, a privately-owned shopping mall decide that those handicapped parking spots up front are a waste of space, HB2 allows for their elimination. One can imagine that more than a few conservative voters may use those spots from time to time, right? Get fired from your job just before your retirement benefits kick in? Think you've been discriminated against because you're too old? Forget about going to court, even though you've been voting 'R' all the time. And to those conservative pregnant women out there looking for employment... please don't complain when no one hires you because you're expectant. The ability of the Republican Party to get conservative voters to repeatedly punch themselves in their own faces is surely a marvel to observe, and would be humorous were its result not so tragic.

HB2 is not legislation. It is hatred. Advocating for the repeal of HB2, while necessary, does little to prevent extremists from replicating laws similar to it in the future. The only way to do that is to cease electing into office people who hate everyone while helping no one with anything. When we cease punching ourselves in the face while fending off imaginary ghosts perhaps then we shall get the government which looks out for us rather than themselves.

amanda ashley, a trans-lesbian woman, is a 32-year resident of Orange and Chatham Counties, particularly the towns of Chapel Hill and Carrboro. She has been involved in local graphic arts, music, school issues, and politics; having run for the mayoral office of Carrboro in 2009.

Coal Ash Risks in Chatham County

by Judy Hogan

It's true that in Moncure and southeast Chatham we are dealing with the worst risks. Three fourths of a million tons of coal ash have arrived by train and truck in our community, but Chatham at large is at risk, too. The County Commissioners set up air monitoring near the Brickhaven site, and the coal ash toxins being measured, including the very finest and most toxic heavy metals, are increasing. Not yet to dangerous levels, but the silicon dust is 200 percent higher than in the baseline testing, and that leads to silicosis, a lung disease.

We learned from Dr. Rebecca Fry of the UNC Superfund that pregnant women, unborn babies and little children are the most at-risk from even small amounts of Chromium 6, lead, mercury, arsenic, vanadium, radioactivity, etc. We learned from Dr. Avner Vengosh of Duke University's Nicholas Center for the Environment that coal ash pollution like ours travels. Our coal ash dust can blow to China, and theirs to us. If it can reach China, it can certainly reach Pittsboro, Siler City, Goldston, Fearrington Village and the Governor's Club. The plan is to move 12 million tons to Brickhaven. For us older people, it's not devastating so fast, yet these metals cause cancer, stomach and nerve problems, and they kill. One of the ways they are definitely entering the air is from the movement of the ash from train cars to trucks at the site and then dumped into the big hole in the ground, where it is moved around by bull-dozers. People living close to the train tracks note four long trains of 100 cars or more are passing in a 24-hour period. They can smell the ash, a sure sign that tiny, invisible particles are in the air.

What are we at Chatham Citizens Against Coal Ash Dump doing? We're fighting the permits in court that the Department of Environmental Quality issued last summer to Charah, the coal ash management company for Duke Energy. We're also educating. Evidence is out that the DEQ pressured the state Health Department to rescind the "do not drink letters" to folks Duke Energy found had contaminated wells near their coal ash sites. Duke didn't want those letters to go out, so "do drink" letters went out.

The leachate, the water that flows through the coal ash, from the Brickhaven site is taken now to the Sanford Waste Water Treatment plant, but Dr. Vengosh made it clear that the usual



Tom Augspurger (left), US Fish and Wildlife Service, taking core sample during reconnaissance of Dan River coal ash spill. From the left: Tom Augspurger, USFWS, John Fridell, USFWS, Rick Smith, Duke Energy. PHOTO BY STEVE ALEXANDER, USFWS

treatment of waste water will not take the toxic metals out of that leachate. It needs a different treatment. The plan now is to dilute it, send back to the river, and the sludge goes onto fields, some of which are in Chatham and used to grow food for animals.

If you want to help us, please donate to our legal efforts. John Runkle is doing a great job challenging the permits, which should never have been issued, but going to court takes more money than we can easily raise here: CCACAD, 248 Buckhorn Rd, Moncure, NC 27559.

Judy Hogan, author, poet, creative writing teacher is the Chair of CCACAD, and lives on one of the truck routes, Moncure-Pittsboro Rd. You may contact her at judyhogan@mindspring.com

Friendly Fire

by John Heuer

Why would the US recruit, hire, train and deploy rebels in Syria to fight the Bashar al Assad government and then bomb them? (US Friendly Fire Kills Syrian Allies, Wall Street Journal June 11, 2016.) This is 2016 after all, the age of precision weapons and smart bombs. An earlier friendly fire incident occurred in Fallujah, Iraq in December, 2015, when US led coalition forces apparently bombed Iraqi security forces fighting the so-called Islamic State.

No one has called the US attack on the Doctors Without Borders hospital in Kunduz, Afghanistan last October that killed 50 staff, patients and visitors "friendly fire."

So what is the difference between friendly and unfriendly fire? When US Army Ranger Pat Tillman was killed in Afghanistan in 2004, his death was initially described as a heroic defense of his comrades under withering enemy fire. When the US Army could no longer maintain this fiction, it finally conceded that Tillman was a victim of "friendly fire," killed by a fellow US Army Ranger.

When Daniel Ellsberg released the Pentagon papers in 1971, Henry Kissinger referred to Ellsberg as "the most dangerous man in America." Why? Because Ellsberg pulled the veil from decades of false information fed to the American people by Republican and Democratic administrations about the American war in Vietnam. Was 1971 the last time the US government and Department of Defense misled the American public?

Obviously not if it was still pedaling fictions about the likes of Pat Tillman in 2004.

When *Time* magazine reviewed the documentary film *The Tillman Story*, the reviewer was straightforward about the falsehoods spread by the Defense Department. Yet, in the same issue, *Time* reported Defense Department statements about "progress" in the wars in Afghanistan and Iraq as gospel fact. Why? Reports of progress in the US-led wars in Afghanistan (since 2001) and Iraq (since 2003) are just as fictitious as reports of progress in the war on Vietnam up until the day the US lost the war.

In fact, US military policy has been bankrupt since we dropped the atomic bombs on Hiroshima and Nagasaki.

In 1979, Charlotte Knaub left her comfortable Montana home to serve as a child immunologist in a Cambodian refugee camp in Thailand. Among the observations Knaub makes in her memoir about her relief service, the flood of refugees in Southeast Asia, as well as the genocides and ecocides, were all set in motion by the US war against Vietnam, Laos and Cambodia.

The other observation she makes is that those leaders making wars need to serve the refugee populations they create in order to understand the consequences of their actions. In fact, then First Lady Rosalyn Carter led a fact-finding mission to Southeast Asia in 1979 that met Charlotte Knaub's medical relief team.

Fast forward 37 years and the world is facing another flood of refugees triggered by the US invasions of Afghanistan and Iraq in 2001 and 2003, as well as subsequent and ongoing US military aggression against Pakistan, Yemen, Libya, Somalia and Syria.

One might think the US would learn the horrific consequences of its military aggression. Then again, there is a bottomless pit of profit for the weapons makers, and even "friendly fire" and hospital bombings deplete stocks of missiles and bombs which, of course, must be replenished.

The trick is that the US government must keep lying to itself and the American public to justify its continued military gravy train, with the ever-present fear that the public may one day wise up to this charade. That's why the government goes after whistleblowers with a vengeance. Any government employee with the courage to expose official government corruption must be silenced to demonstrate to other employees that any unauthorized truth-telling will not be tolerated. The same is true for anyone who defies the official US policy.

The most widely celebrated American athlete, Muhammad Ali, who died on June 3rd, cited his Muslim beliefs in declaring his refusal to be drafted into the US Army during the Vietnam War. Contrast Ali's principled stand against an immoral war with the countless Christians that persecuted and prosecuted him for his act of conscience.

Now listen to all the hysterical voices crying out for vengeance against Arabs and the Muslim world used to justify making endless war in the Middle East. Anything to keep the money flowing to the war machine, despite the failure of every US military effort since WW II. As long as the money flows, it doesn't matter how many wars are lost, or how many enemies are made in the process.

John Heuer is a regular contributor to Chatham County Line. A Pittsboro resident, he is active in Peace Now and NC Veterans for Peace.

Change is life’s only certainty, except with vending machines

by Julian Sereno

Change is coming to Chatham County Line — both the print and the online editions.

Let’s start with the printed paper. Some of you, 5,000 in all, have been getting Chatham County Line delivered to your mailboxes this year. Recent issues have come with an full-color coupon insert. Coupons don’t really work well as print advertisements in the newspaper, but they work great on sheets, designed to be clipped, inserted in the paper. Advertisers who buy print ads — which is what keeps the paper alive — will have 9,000 copies of their ads circulated rather than the 4,000 it was last year. It’s win-win-win — for regular print advertisers, for those who want coupons, and for readers who will have the paper delivered to their mailbox.

The coupon sheet is the product of Circle City Advertising, a new venture of Lesley Landis and Randy Voller. Lesley Landis is a graphic designer and civic activist, founder of the Wake Up Wednesday networking group and officer in a variety of arts and cultural groups. Currently, she’s board secretary at the Chatham Arts Council. Randy Voller, her husband, is former Mayor of Pittsboro, former chair of first the Chatham and then the North Carolina State Democratic Party. He is currently a

delegate to the Democratic National Convention in Philadelphia pledged to Bernie Sanders. Randy is also a consultant to the developers of Chatham Park, Preston Development.

Lesley and Randy have always been great supporters of this newspaper. For years they have used it to publicize their interests and causes by writing articles and buying ads. Writing articles and buying ads is the key to this paper’s sustainability. They are launching their color coupon clipper to help local businesses get the word out while supporting another local business, Chatham County Line.

Chatham Park has recently been figuring in the article/ad mix. In this issue, one of it’s planners, Thomas D’Alessandro, describes concepts underlying their plans on the front page. Chatham Park’s continued embrace would make this paper sustainable for the foreseeable future. All the same, this paper won’t shut anybody up, as long as they keep a civil tongue, or rather a civil keyboard. Our motto remains “where all voices are heard.”

And speaking of voices, there should be plenty of new ones and many will be heard only on our website, www.chatham-countyline.org. Gaines Steer, whose series about Columbia, Maryland concludes with this issue, has become Chatham County Line’s first Outreach Coordinator. (Note: he is not, nor

has he ever claimed to be, the Publisher of Chatham County Line. That was the Raleigh *News and Observer’s* screw up.)

Gaines’s enthusiasm has already led to some interesting articles. Specifically, Melody Troncale’s article in this print issue and Cynthia Raxter, the producer of the Bynum Front Porch Storytelling shows, has an article posted on the online issue. You can also read an online article by Gaines introducing himself.

Gaines remains active in the Men’s Movement, which we hope to cover regularly in our online issue. I participated in the Men’s Movement 25 years ago, and benefited greatly from it. I hope that through www.chathamcountyline.org, many more men will benefit, as will the women in their lives.

We are hoping for an online paper that is the same as the printed paper — entirely based on local, original articles. Start clicking on it every week or so and there should be something good that you won’t find anywhere else.

Plus ça change, plus c’est la même chose — the more it changes, the more it is the same. With all this change, Chatham County Line’s goal is to remain the same — interesting, original and local.

Julian Sereno is editor and publisher of Chatham County Line.

Hope and Change

by Don Lein

“It is difficult to free fools from the chains they revere.” — Voltaire

We are now nearing the end of the Obama years and it is appropriate to assess how well he has done on his vacuous promise of hope and change. It also is appropriate to assess how well our first Black President did. On that point, there is some dispute, since Dr. Ben Carson who grew up in a black ghetto, states that Obama cannot relate to the black experience, since he “grew up white” with his formative years being spent in Indonesia and therefore cannot identify with the typical American black experience. It is more of an abstraction to him, than reality.

However, criteria more relevant to him and Hillary, are those espoused by Saul Alinsky. In all fairness Alinsky merely restated the ideas of Marx/Lenin and we all know how they turned out in real life – see Cuba, Venezuela, the Iron Curtain countries. Alinsky, et. al., were interested in controlling the people and they would do this through controlling their health-care firstly (remember Hillarycare preceded Obamacare), then institute programs that would create more poverty (such as \$15/hour minimum wage) which would then be alleviated by government controlled programs (welfare) to raise them to a subsistence level, where they are easier to control. The government should raise debt to an unsustainable level so that confiscatory taxes are more palatable – creating even more poverty. The educational system should be controlled and it is, through massive infusion of dollars, which can be withheld. The university/collegiate world is not a problem since it has evolved to a monoculture supportive of socialism, becoming embryos of social unrest, turning out perpetual adolescents. Removal of God from the public square is essential as is the removal of guns from the citizenry. One of the areas that Alinsky would give Obama a summa cum laude would be class warfare. The country has never been more divided than under his “leadership” – Hillary might be able to better his record of divisiveness, but Obama has set a high standard.

Interfering with this ritual passing of the baton to Hillary

which the media is doing everything it can to facilitate, an incident occurred in Orlando which muddled the waters. A gay Muslim registered Democrat walked into a bar and slaughtered 49 people and injured many more. He had been to the bar a number of times for casual “hookups”, so his presence was not noteworthy. He did call a number of outlets to let them know something was happening and pledging his allegiance to his religion. He had been investigated by the FBI twice and was not on any lists of provocateurs. However his timing was inconvenient for the administration following on a number of other Muslim terrorist attacks, implying the administration was soft on Islamic Terrorism. This is particularly embarrassing for the Commander in Chief, since he referred to ISIS/ISIL as the “JV team”, but we seem unable to deal with them.

It didn’t help the CIC’s cause when he refused to acknowledge the fact of “Islamic Terrorism”. Had this been the first time of denial of this phenomenon, there may have been some credibility but since we encountered this last leap year in connection with Benghazi, when in September 2012, Susan Rice made the rounds of Sunday talks shows to peddle the now-admitted lie of blaming the attacks on our Libyan embassy as being a reaction to an amateur video. This time it is Loretta Lynch who is releasing the tapes of the calls from the gay, Muslim, Democrat with the pledges of faith to Islam redacted, apparently believing that we will ignore that fact. While the New York Times and their acolytes will do that, real journalists will not. Of course, Hillary’s hands are not clean, since she and Bill will not release how many millions of laundered dollars are in the Clinton Foundation from Muslim countries. “Oh what a tangled web we weave when first we practice to deceive.” One would hope the Clintons would be more sophisticated about it by now, since they have been practicing the art of deception for decades.

However, what of “hope and change”? Bill Clinton in one of his more honest evaluations, referred to “the awful legacy of the last eight years”. Hope and change, in fact, have turned out to be doubling of the federal debt which necessitates zero interest rates which in turn precludes growth – which has been the worst since the Great Depression. The president brags

about the 5 percent unemployment rate, but that is only if you use Obamamath, which overlooks those no longer looking for jobs which in May amounted to over 94 million – again the highest percentage since the Great Depression. His foreign policy has been justly characterized as near anarchy with no discernible leadership shown by this administration – neither Obama nor Clinton!! Race relations are an absolute disaster – again that may be because of Dr. Carson’s point that race relations were an abstract concept to Obama, not something he has experienced firsthand. Immigration is Orwellian in that over 300 jurisdictions have declared themselves immune from Federal Law and become sanctuary cities. This unchecked and illegal immigration has, among other things, resulted in over 1 million illegal aliens being arrested and they now make up 30 percent of the federal inmate population – all in the name of diversity and multi-culturalism!!! “Awful legacy” is understating the disaster!!

Perhaps the best explanation for this disaster is an expansion of Dr. Carson’s observation that not only has he not grown up “Black” but he also has not grown up “American”. In numerous speeches, most recently, at Howard University he refers to “luck” in making people successful and/or his comments that “you didn’t build that”. He doesn’t understand the entrepreneurial mindset, risk taking and the rewards of the Puritan work ethic. Mitch Daniels, President of Purdue, in a graduation speech took a more traditional American view, stated that he hoped “you will tune out anyone who says your achievements are not your own” and he cited three quotes: Thomas Edison – “opportunity is missed by most people because it is dressed in overalls and looks like work.”; Samuel Goldwyn- “the harder I work, the luckier I get”; Frederick Douglass- “We may explain success mainly by one word, and that word is work.” Not only hasn’t Obama grown up black, but he has never been exposed to the marvelous results that come from human toil – how sad!!

Don Lein is a regular contributor to Chatham County Line. A Chatham resident, he is involved in a variety of civic organizations.

Advice unheeded

by Jeff Davidson

In the course of our careers we generate wonderful ideas for our friends and family, or for our customers and clients and, thankfully, many times they actually follow through on our suggestions.

Years ago, I was a full-time management consultant in Falls Church, Virginia. I had a client who was a very successful dentist in Arlington Virginia. He was about to launch a second office in the Pentagon Concourse. If you’re not familiar with the Pentagon, a subway stop opens up to the Pentagon Concourse, a small shopping area primarily for Pentagon employees. From the Concourse one can walk a long hallway and reach the actual Pentagon building itself.

The Pentagon Concourse contains a variety of convenience stores such as a small grocery market, a dry cleaning service, a tailor, and a post office substation. My client had secured the large corner space, ideally located within the Concourse. Among my many tasks in helping him to establish a successful office was to establish a name for the dental practice.

A STROKE OF GENIUS?

He had suggested names such as “Pentagon Dentistry” or “Concourse Dentistry.” I derived a name which I felt was one for the ages, the “Department of Tooth Defense.” With a large sign over his entrance, including a mock-up to resemble the symbol for the U.S. Department of Defense, he could capture the attention

of everyone coming or going in the Pentagon Concourse.

To my knowledge here was the only dental office that would ever be situated within close proximity to the Department of Defense, with its headquarters in the Pentagon. The “Department of Tooth Defense” was bold, humorous, and right for the situation.

Alas, the situation became a tragedy of sorts: to my dismay, he chose not to take the title, and so my best advice went unheeded.

A FISHY ANGLE

Another time I was working with a seafood restaurant at Fisherman’s Wharf, in San Francisco. The owner was searching for a memory hook, a tagline that he could employ on all of his literature, brochures about the restaurant, the menu, his website, and so on.

We discussed a variety of potential taglines, ruminating on phraseology such as “the freshest fish in San Francisco” or “San Francisco’s freshest fish.” Those were adequate, but I felt that they were quite ordinary. After some deliberation and in consideration of the restaurant’s proximity to San Francisco Bay – it was within a stone’s throw – I offered him with the following tagline: “For fresher fish, you’ll have to jump in the bay.”

Voila! I had uncorked it. It was perfect, the kind of tagline that you can’t predict will emerge but when it does, you’re proud of it. It contained the alliteration, “fresher fish,” and now had an action associated with it, jumping into the bay. Who else in San Francisco could make that claim. Who else could derive such a tagline?

Whoa is me: as with the dentist in the Pentagon Concourse, the seafood restaurant owner did not opt to employ the tagline.

Nor would he consider any variations of it. Jumping in the bay didn’t make sense to him. I explained that we didn’t advocate anyone should jump in the bay, we implied that jumping in the bay was the only way to get fresher fish than what you’re served right here, in the restaurant. It was of no use. He couldn’t see it.

APPRECIATE OTHERS

What I found particularly disappointing was not so much that the clients didn’t like my ideas but rather they reverted to safe, bland, and undistinguished alternatives. Yet I was retained because the clients presumably wanted a different approach in the first place. So, even if the specific idea I offered were not to their liking, they still could have stayed on track and sought provocative, on-target solutions. It’s those solutions that propel businesses forward, not sticking to the same tired script when change is needed.

It is said that the customer or client is always right. We know that this is not the case. Many clients are mistaken in some way but we have to allow them the space, and convey with grace, that we appreciate their feelings, opinions, and perspectives.

It is clients like the dentist and the restaurant owner who make me appreciate all the rest: the clients who appropriately act when an opportunity arises.

Jeff Davidson of Durham is a regular contributor to Chatham County Line. He is “The Work-Life Balance Expert®”, the premier thought leader on work-life balance issues, Jeff is the author of 65 books, among them Breathing Space, Dial it Down, Live it Up, Simpler Living, 60 Second Innovator, and 60 Second Organizer. Visit www.BreathingSpace.com



Chatham County Line necesita noticias bilingües de la comunidad Hispano de Chatham

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TUE Hot Ham & Cheddar with lettuce, tomato, garlic aioli, brioche roll

WED 4-oz Local Beef Burger with lettuce, tomato, onion, brioche roll

THU Fried Chicken Tender Sandwich w/lettuce, tomato, ranch dressing, brioche roll

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PITTSBORO ROADHOUSE JULY/AUG MUSIC

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and all July/August events.

7/9: Tim Hair

7/10: John Westmoreland

7/11: Mr. Wonderful

7/12: Faith Bardill

7/14: String Peddlers

7/15: All My Rowdy Friends

7/16: Good Rocking Sam

7/17: Will Baker

7/19: Ton Galiani Jazz Trio

7/21: Erich & Lisa

7/22: be the moon

7/23: The NC Revelers Orchestra

7/24: Dennis Cash

7/26: Dave and Rory

7/28: String Peddlers

7/29: Last Tuesday

7/30: Thunderstruck - AC/DC Tribute Band

7/31: Brittany Davis

8/1: The NC Revelers Orchestra

8/2: Jacob Vaughan

8/4: John Stevens

8/5: The Commanders

8/6: Megan Doss

8/7: Dave Corlett

8/8: Mr. Wonderful

8/13: Eli Craig Band

8/18: Glenn Jones

8/19: Laura Jane Vincent

8/20: Ukelele Orchestra (UNC Fundraiser)

8/21: Thunder & Spice

8/25: Dennis Cash

8/27: the Willie Painter Band

8/28: John Stevens

9/2: Ozymandias

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